measures that bridged the gap between India and the diaspora. In 2017, the report of the working group on migration was released by the ministry of housing and urban poverty alleviation, which analysed the policy gaps associated with internal migration. It observed that while in theory, freedom of movement was guaranteed by the Constitution of India under Article 19, in practice, there were considerable bottle necks that restricted mobility. The major problem identified was that public welfare services were tied to local or domiciled areas and did not move with the migrant. It therefore argued for greater portability of public services to facilitate easier and safer migration, marking a big shift from earlier policies that were explicitly designed to curtail migration. The report also argued for migrant helplines, more options for rental housing, dormitories for female migrants in cities and inter-state coordination of migrant welfare services to provide food security and better health and education. It also pointed out the need for better data on migration so that policy debates are informed by evidence and not empty rhetoric. The *Economic Survey of India 2016–17*, published by the ministry of finance, ran a full chapter on internal migration for the first time in its history, highlighting the scale and extent of the phenomenon.

Outside the government, firms especially those working in the field of financial inclusion, began to provide customized solutions for migrant workers. Non-Governmental Organizations (NGOs) also pitched in with innovative ideas. The Aajeevika Bureau in western India, for instance, is an NGO solely devoted to the welfare of migrant workers, in the source and destination region. Among other services, it provides identity cards for migrant workers that enable access to various other services in cities, skill training and legal education and aid. There is therefore a perceptible shift in attitudes to both internal and international migration taking place currently in India. But what does the future hold in store? If humankind survives till the 22nd century and the map of internal and international economic inequalities gets redrawn, would there be political parties in Bihar that shun Maharashtrian migrants or Indian A1 visas rationed out to the Americans?